

3.6 Statistical Enquiry Cycle (SEC)

The Statistical Enquiry Cycle (SEC) underpins the study of Statistics. Students need to be able to apply the knowledge and techniques outlined in this section within the framework of the SEC. The cycle covers five stages:

- initial planning
- data collection
- data processing and presentation
- interpretation of results
- evaluation and review.

The detail of the SEC that is common to all exam boards is provided in [Appendix 3: statistical enquiry cycle](#) (page 43). During their learning students should develop their understanding of the SEC through a variety of authentic contexts. Practical experience of the cycle is integral to their understanding of the principles of the SEC.